

Soohwan Lee

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Human-centered AI | Human-AI Collaboration | CSCW | Conversational AI | Group Dynamics

RESEARCH STATEMENT

My research investigates how AI-mediated systems shape group dynamics and social influence beyond the individual level. Drawing on social psychological theories, I understand, design, and empirically study interactive AI systems that intervene in group processes to enhance collective intelligence, improve decision-making quality, and foster creative collaboration.

I advance the concept of Group-Centered AI, reframing user experience as collective and emergent rather than an aggregation of individual interactions. AI has the potential to fundamentally reshape social dynamics, and understanding this influence can enable the design of group processes that foster greater inclusivity, diversity, and systems-level thinking. My work aims to inform responsible AI systems that influence groups transparently and ethically while preserving critical thinking and agency.

EDUCATION

- **Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology(UNIST)** (Expected) 2027
Ph.D in Design with Concentration in HCI
◦ Advisor: Kyungho Lee
Ulsan, South Korea
- **Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology(UNIST)** 2022
M.S in Creative Design Engineering with Concentration in HCI
◦ Committee: Kyungho Lee(Chair), Ian Oakley, Young-woo Park
Ulsan, South Korea
- **Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology(UNIST)** 2020
B.S in Human Factors Engineering & Computer Science and Engineering
Ulsan, South Korea

EXPERIENCE

- **Ulsan National Institute of Science and Technology (UNIST)** Ulsan, South Korea
 - **Research Assistant** 03/2020 – Present
Expressive Computing Lab, UNIST (Advisor: Kyungho Lee)
 - **Research Intern** 12/2018 – 12/2019
Interactions Lab, UNIST (Advisor: Ian Oakley)
- **University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC)** Champaign, IL, United States
 - **Entrepreneurship & Data Science Summer Camp** 07/2019
Data Analysis and Consulting for Start-ups at UIUC

PUBLICATIONS

C=CONFERENCE, J=JOURNAL, S=SHORT PAPER AND POSTER, T=THESIS, U=UNDER REVIEW

[Peer-reviewed Conference Proceedings]

- [C.1] **Soohwan Lee** and Kyungho Lee. (2026). **Understanding Compliance and Conversion Dynamics in Multi-Agent Collectives**. In Proceedings of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'26)
- [C.2] **Soohwan Lee**, Seoyeong Hwang, Ian Oakley, and Kyungho Lee. (2024). **Expanding the Design Space of Vision-based Interactive Systems for Group Dance Practice**. In Proceedings of the 2024 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS'24)
- [C.3] DoYoung Lee, **Soohwan Lee**, and Ian Oakley. (2020). **Nailz: Sensing Hand Input with Touch Sensitive Nails**. In Proceedings of the 2020 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '20)

[Journal Publications]

- [J.1] Jang, Sangsu, **Soohwan Lee**, Temirlan Dzhoroiev, Taeyoon Kim, Hyejin Oh, Nari Kim, and Young-Woo Park (2021). **Design Guidelines for Contextual Awareness and Management of Hygiene in Daily Life with Infectious Viruses**. Archives of Design Research

[Short Papers, Posters, and Workshop Papers]

- [S.1] **Soohwan Lee** (2026). **Understanding and Designing AI Systems that Reshape Social Dynamics in Group Decision-Making**. In Companion Proceedings of the 31th International Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI '26 Companion)
- [S.2] **Soohwan Lee**, Seoyeong Hwang, and Kyungho Lee. (2025). **Beyond Individual UX: Defining Group Experience(GX) as a New Paradigm for Group-centered AI**. In Companion Publication of the 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS'25 Companion)

- [S.3] **Soohwan Lee**, Seoyeong Hwang, Dajung Kim and Kyungho Lee. (2025). **Conversational Agents as Catalysts for Critical Thinking: Challenging Social Influence in Group Decision-making**. In Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '25)
- [S.4] **Soohwan Lee**, Mingyu Kim, Seoyeong Hwang, Dajung Kim and Kyungho Lee. (2025). **Amplifying Minority Voices: AI-Mediated Devil's Advocate System for Inclusive Group Decision-Making**. In Companion Proceedings of the 30th International Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI '25 Companion)
- [S.5] **Soohwan Lee**, Seoyeong Hwang, and Kyungho Lee. (2024). **Conversational Agents as Catalysts for Critical Thinking: Challenging Design Fixation in Group Design**. (DIS '24 Workshop)
- [S.6] **Soohwan Lee**, and Kyungho Lee. (2023). **CheerUp: A Real-time Ambient Visualization of Cheerleading Pose Similarity**. In Companion Proceedings of the 28th International Conference on Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI '23 Companion)
- [Thesis]
- [T.1] **Soohwan Lee**. (2022). **NEAS: AI-based Interactive System to Support Non-verbal Expressions in Online Communication**. Master Thesis, UNIST.
- [Domestic Conference (*written in Korean)]
- [D.1] **Soohwan Lee**, and Kyungho Lee. (2021). **NEAS: AI-based Interactive System to Support Non-verbal Expressions in Online Communication**. In Proceedings of 2021 Fall KSDS
- [D.2] Nari Kim, **Soohwan Lee**, Hyejin Oh, Temirlan Dzhorojev, and Young-Woo Park. (2021). **Interactive system design in everyday life to improve the perception of environmental hygiene information in pandemic situations**. In Proceedings of 2021 Spring KSDS
- [D.3] **Soohwan Lee**, and Kyungho Lee. (2021). **An Interactive Visualization of Gayageum's Expression and Mid-Air Gesture Recognition**. In Proceedings of 2021 Spring KSDS
- [D.4] **Soohwan Lee**, Kyungho Lee, and Young-Woo Park. (2021). **Counterfunctional Music Player with Mid-air Hand Gesture**. In Proceedings of HCI Korea 2021 (Creative Award)
- [Under Review (TBD)]
- [U.1] **Soohwan Lee**, Seoyeong Hwang, Mingyu Kim, Dajung Kim, and Kyungho Lee. TBD. **Investigating LLM-Powered Minority Support in Power-Imbalanced Group Decision-Making: Counterargument and Mediation as Intervention Strategies**. (Conference Paper)
- [U.2] **Soohwan Lee**, Kyungho Lee. TBD. **Reinforce, Align, or Oscillate? How People Experience and Interpret Multi-Agent Social Influence Over Time**. (Conference Paper)
- [U.3] Seoyeong Hwang, Soohyun Hwang, **Soohwan Lee**, Dajung Kim, and Kyungho Lee. TBD. **Augmentary: Exploring How LLM-Based Journaling Systems Can Support Reflective Writing and Autonomous Meaning-Making**. (Conference Paper)
- [U.4] **Soohwan Lee**, Seoyeong Hwang, and Kyungho Lee. TBD. **Reframing Supporting Minority Influence in the Age of AI: Bridging Theory, Design, and Simulation for Inclusive Group Decision-Making**. (Book Chapter)
- [U.5] **Soohwan Lee**, Soobin Lee and Kyungho Lee. TBD. **Expression2Emoji: Designing Non-verbal Communication Support Tool for Group Video Meetings**. (Conference Paper)

PROJECTS

- | | |
|---|-------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Development of a Smart CMF Recommendation and 3D Manufacturing Integration System
This work was supported by the Design Industry Technology Development Program (25457764, Smart CMF Design Recommendation and Real-Time Collaborative 3D Simulation System) funded By the Ministry of Trade, Industry and Resources (MOTIR, Republic of Korea). | 10/2025 - Present |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Commercialization design and development of Intelligent Product-Service System for personalized full silver life cycle care
This work was supported by the Technology Innovation Program (20015056, Commercialization design and development of Intelligent Product-Service System for personalized full silver life cycle care) funded By the Ministry of Trade, Industry & Energy(MOTIE, Republic of Korea). | 01/2022 - 12/2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Development sensor modules and mountings for monitoring upper body angles and angular velocities
This work was supported by LG Electronics. | 01/2024 - 09/2024 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Building an end-to-end speech recognition model for active seniors using KoSpeech model
This research was supported by X-Corps Plus program of National Research Foundation of Korea(NRF) funded by the Ministry of Science, Republic of Korea, ICT (No. 2021H1D8A306520712). | 03/2023 - 12/2023 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Smart Clean BioAir Home Management System
This work was supported by the Technology Innovation Program (20009977, Smart Clean BioAir Home Management System) funded By the Ministry of Trade, Industry & Energy(MOTIE, Republic of Korea). | 04/2020 - 12/2021 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • UNIVERSE: Design of a Social Robot that Supports Emotional Well-Being of the MZ Gen
This work was supported by Innovative Education Center, UNIST. (This project is part of AI Challenger Program at UNIST.) | 09/2021 - 12/2021 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Conceptualize and design a new UX/UI for a washer/dryer targeting Gen MZ.
This work was supported by LG Electronics. | 03/2021 - 09/2021 |

TEACHING

- **Teaching Assistant**
UNI207::Creative Computing for Emerging Media ART, UNIST
- 07/2022 - 08/2022

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **CES Innovation Awards**
2025 Honoree in Smart Home
- 2025


INVITED TALKS

- **Collaborating with AI in Groups: A Design Research Approach to Social Influence**
Group Dynamics & Social Change Lab, Lehigh University (Hosted by Dr.Jiin Jung)
- 04/2025

ACADEMIC SERVICES

[Organizing Committee]

- **ACM IUI Student Volunteer Co-Chair**
- 2027

[Program Committee]

- **ACM CHI Poster Associate Chair**
 - **ACM DIS PWiP Associate Chair**
 - **ACM IUI Program Committee**
 - **ACM IUI HealthIUI Workshop Program Committee**
- 2026
2025 - 2026
2026
2026

[Reviewer]

Have reviewed 48 submissions in total, including full papers and posters.
5 Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews: CHI'26, IUI'26, UIST'25, DIS'25 Paper, CHI'25 LBW

- **ACM CHI(26), CSCW(24), DIS(25-26), IUI(26), FAccT(26), UIST(25), C&C(26), AlpCHI(26) Paper Reviewer**
 - **ACM CHI(25-26), CSCW(25), IUI(26), CUI(25), DIS(25-26) Poster & LBW & PWiP Reviewer**
 - **International Journal of Human-computer Interaction Reviewer**
- 2024 - 2026
2025 - 2026
2026